

MTV'S SHIFT MUSIC VIDEOS TO REALITY TV



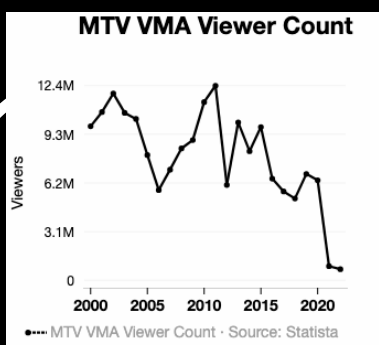
The Real World (1992) was MTV's first step in the world of reality television. Early ratings reached 3x higher than music videos, which started the quick change to reality TV.



WHY DOES IT MATTER?

MTV started the trend of over-the-top music videos and gave musicians/artists a platform to show off their creativity.

While switching from music videos removed that platform, it gave teens a place to indulge in their "rebellious" interests by featuring more youth-oriented pop-culture. Its evolution helped shape the entertainment industry and cable programming.



MIXED REVIEWS

"I miss the old MTV"
Despite receiving many complaints, MTV viewers actually responded really well to reality shows.

The low cost and **high demand** for *dramatic* reality TV solidified MTV's decision to keep the switch.

DID IT WORK?

MTV has seen both pros and cons since their switch, including the creation of the VMAs (however, they have slowly lost viewership)!



- The **VMAs** were created and featured live performances
- **Ridiculousness** uses internet videos to create a successful show from pre-existing content
- With the rise of **YouTube**, the need for music videos on TV has decreased



- **Jersey Shore** received criticism for its negative portrayal of New Jersey and Italian Americans
- Lost its influence as social media became bigger and viewers were able to find gossip and updates online!

MTV'S MOST POPULAR SHOWS & PERSONALITIES

From drama filled reality tv, to disgusting stunts and new internet personalities, MTV was full of trendy new content!



JERSEY SHORE

Jersey Shore was MTV's first big hit and most-watched series premiere ever, with 8.45 million viewers tuning in on January 6, 2011.



JACKASS

Connecticut Senator Joe Lieberman criticized the show, which added to MTV's reputation of being rebellious and trendy for teens (and increased the shows popularity!)



ROB DYRDEK & RIDICULOUSNESS

MTV president of programming Susanne Daniels said that Dyrdek is an essential part of MTV. She praised his appeal to millennials and his ability to connect with audiences.



WHAT WAS THE LASTING EFFECT?

VIEWERSHIP



MTV was a major factor in the rise of cable programming in the 1990s. MTV's music videos became irrelevant and obsolete when YouTube and Myspace started to take off.

REPUTATION



MTV's reputation went downhill since the switch, with some saying the channel would rather prioritize money and views over the original and loved purpose, music.

MONEY



MTV started seeing **more** profit because reality shows are relatively cheap to produce (no need for professional actors and writers, and often didn't require a unionized crew).

MTV FUN FACTS!

- MTV had a policy of not financing music videos, instead expecting record companies to pay for them.



- Jackson funded his video by charging MTV and Showtime \$250k for the rights of the BTS movie
- MTV was originally only available in a few thousand households in New Jersey. It took several years for MTV to be carried nationwide.
- The first video featured on MTV was "Video Killed the Radio Star" on August 1, 1981 at 12:01 AM